

# Word family: \*\*holiday / holidays / holidaying / holidaymaker\*\*

\*\*Base word:\*\* holiday

\*\*Plural:\*\* holidays

\*\*ing form:\*\* holidaying

\*\*Related form:\*\* holidaymaker

\*\*Part of speech:\*\* noun ( 名詞 ) / verb ( 動詞 , 較英式 )

Your sentence:

> “I saw it about two years ago when I was on \*\*holiday\*\* with my family in Okinawa, Japan.”

## Meaning in this passage

Here, \*\*holiday\*\* means a \*\*period of time when you travel or take a break from work/school for rest and enjoyment\*\*.

\*\*繁體中文\*\*： \*\*離開日常工作或學業去休息、旅行或度假的一段時間；假期 / 度假\*\*

\*\*中文翻譯\*\*：

> “...when I was on \*\*holiday\*\* with my family in Okinawa...”

「.....當時我和家人正在沖繩\*\*度假\*\*.....」

Here:

\*\*be on holiday = 正在度假 / 放假\*\*

---

# 1. \*\*holiday = period away from work/school for rest or travel ( 假期 / 度假 ) — 假期；度假\*\*

This is the meaning used in your passage.

\*\*Meaning:\*\* A period when someone is not working or studying and may travel, rest, or enjoy leisure activities.

### Practice 1 — Original

> “I was on \*\*holiday\*\* with my family in Okinawa.”

「我當時和家人正在沖繩\*\*度假\*\*。」

### Practice 2

> “We’re going on \*\*holiday\*\* next month.”

「我們下個月要去\*\*度假\*\*。」

### ### Practice 3

> “She spent the summer \*\*holiday\*\* by the sea.”

「她在海邊度過暑假。」

**\*\*holiday = 暫時離開工作或學業，用來休息、旅行或娛樂的一段假期\*\***

Common:

- \* go on holiday
- \* be on holiday
- \* summer holiday
- \* family holiday

---

# 2. **\*\*holiday = official/public day when people do not work ( 公共假日 ) — 假日；公眾假期\*\***

**\*\*Holiday\*\*** can also mean a specific day officially set aside for celebration, remembrance, religion, or rest.

### ### Practice 4

> “Monday is a public \*\*holiday\*\*.”

「星期一是公眾\*\*假期\*\*。」

### ### Practice 5

> “Banks are closed on national \*\*holidays\*\*.”

「銀行在國家\*\*假日\*\*休息。」

**\*\*holiday = 因法定、宗教、紀念或公共原因而不用正常上班 / 上課的特定日子\*\***

This is distinct from a vacation period.

---

# 3. **\*\*holiday = festival/celebration period ( 節日 ) — 節日；節慶\*\***

Especially in American English, **holiday** can refer to a major festival or celebration.

#### ### Practice 6

> “Christmas is an important **holiday** for many families.”

「聖誕節對很多家庭來說是一個重要**節日**。」

#### ### Practice 7

> “People travel a lot during the **holiday** season.”

「人們在**節日期間**經常出行。」

**holiday** = 具有宗教、文化或社會意義的節日 / 節慶時期

For strict counting, I would keep this close to Meaning 2, since both concern specially designated non-ordinary days, but it is useful to show explicitly because British and American usage differs.

---

# 4. **holiday** = school break ( 學校 ) — 學校假期

In British English, **holiday** is commonly used for school breaks.

#### ### Practice 8

> “The children are on school **holiday**.”

「孩子們正在放**學校假期**。」

#### ### Practice 9

> “The Easter **holidays** begin next week.”

「復活節**假期**下星期開始。」

**school holiday** = 學校停止上課的一段假期

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 1 as a break from school.

---

# 5. **holiday** = take a vacation ( 動詞 , 較英式 ) — 度假

As a verb, **holiday** can mean to spend time on vacation.

#### ### Practice 10

> “They \*\*holidayed\*\* in Spain last summer.”

「他們去年夏天在西班牙\*\*度假\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 11

> “The family often \*\*holidays\*\* by the coast.”

「這個家庭經常到海邊\*\*度假\*\*。」

**\*\*holiday somewhere = 在某地度假\*\***

This is more common in British English and less common than:

> go on holiday

> vacation

in other varieties.

---

# Related form: **\*\*holidaymaker\*\***

A **\*\*holidaymaker\*\*** is a person who is away on holiday for leisure.

#### ### Practice 12

> “The beach was crowded with **\*\*holidaymakers\*\***.”

「海灘擠滿了**\*\*度假人士 / 遊客\*\***。」

**\*\*holidaymaker = 正在度假旅行的人；英式英語常見\*\***

---

# Important distinction: **\*\*holiday vs vacation\*\***

#### ### British English

**\*\*holiday\*\*** is the common everyday word for:

\* a trip away

\* time off

\* school breaks

### American English

\*\*vacation\*\* is more common for time away from work/school or a leisure trip.

\*\*holiday\*\* more often means:

\* a public/festival day

So your sentence:

> “on holiday”

is very natural British-style English.

In American English:

> “on vacation”

would be more typical.

---

# Important distinction: \*\*holiday vs day off\*\*

### \*\*day off\*\*

= one day when you do not work

### \*\*holiday\*\*

= can be a longer vacation period or an official/public holiday

> “I have a day off on Friday.”

does not necessarily mean:

> “Friday is a holiday.”

---

# Important distinction: \*\*holiday vs break\*\*

### \*\*break\*\*

is broader and means any pause from work, study, or activity.

### \*\*holiday\*\*

usually suggests a recognized period of time away, often for rest or travel.

- > lunch break
- > school holiday

Different scale and function.

---

# Important distinction: \*\*holiday vs trip\*\*

### \*\*trip\*\*

focuses on the journey or visit.

### \*\*holiday\*\*

focuses on leisure time away from normal work/school.

You can take:

- > a business trip

but that is not necessarily:

- > a holiday.

---

# Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- \* \*\*holiday\*\*
- \* \*\*holidays\*\*
- \* \*\*holidaying\*\*
- \* \*\*holidaymaker\*\*

Useful constructions include:

- \* on holiday
- \* go on holiday

- \* public holiday
- \* school holiday
- \* holiday season

The Golden Manual says regional and grammatical distinctions should be included where useful, but closely related settings should still be merged when the underlying meaning remains the same.

#### # Master comparison

| Form / sense                         | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                                | -----                                 |
| <b>**holiday — vacation period**</b> | 離開日常工作或學業去休息、旅行或娛樂的一段假期               |
| <b>**holiday — public day off**</b>  | 因法定、宗教、紀念或公共原因而不用正常上班 / 上課的特定日子       |
| <b>**holiday — festival**</b>        | 具有宗教、文化或社會意義的節日；美式英語尤其常見              |
| <b>**holiday — school break**</b>    | 學校停止上課的一段假期；可併入 vacation-period 義     |
| <b>**holiday — verb**</b>            | 在某地度假；較英式                             |
| <b>**holidaymaker**</b>              | 正在度假的旅客 / 度假人士                        |

#### # For your original sentence

> “...when I was on **\*\*holiday\*\*** with my family in Okinawa...”

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*holiday = 一段離開日常生活去旅行、休息和享受的時間\*\***

So:

> **\*\*be on holiday\*\***

= **\*\*正在度假 / 放假\*\***

For your database, I would count **\*\*3 genuinely useful core meanings\*\*** for **\*\*holiday\*\***:

1. **\*\*a vacation period away from work/school\*\***
2. **\*\*an official/public day off\*\***
3. **\*\*a festival or celebration day\*\***

I would merge **\*\*school holiday\*\*** into #1, keep the verb **\*\*holiday\*\*** as a grammatical extension, and treat **\*\*holidaymaker\*\*** as a family extension rather than inflate the core count.